

PCB-06 · BODY OF KNOWLEDGE — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Using the Body of Knowledge: a guide for employers

Role design, hiring and development built on a published framework rather than a job-advert template

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT

2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.

AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

What a hiring manager can and cannot conclude from a PCL-AI credential, and how to use the underlying thirteen-domain framework for three jobs it does well: writing a role specification that describes competence rather than tools, structuring an interview that tests judgement, and assessing a controls function's capability gaps with a weighted coverage measure. Includes a worked gap assessment and a usable checklist.

— About this document

Document	PCB-06
Series	Body of Knowledge — Executive Summary
Version	1.0
Status	draft
Date	2026-08-04
Unresolved placeholders	2

Notice. This document is an educational publication of Project Controls Institute Global, Inc., and does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, financial or other professional advice. It must not be relied upon as such. Where a topic depends on the contract or the governing law, entitlement and treatment vary by jurisdiction; take local advice.

Standards. Standards and frameworks are referred to by name and described in this publication's own words. No standard's text, tables, diagrams or question banks are reproduced. All trademarks remain the property of their respective owners, and no endorsement by any standards body, employer or vendor is implied or should be inferred.

Status. Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. is a Delaware Non-Stock Corporation. The Institute has been developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by ANAB, IAS or any other accreditation body. It intends to seek 501(c)(3) recognition, which has not been granted. No governmental approval, academic equivalence, or guaranteed employment, promotion or salary outcome is claimed or implied.

Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

© 2026 Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. · All rights reserved.

Contents

1. What the credential tells you before you use the framework	4
2. Using the domains as a role specification	4
3. Using the framework in hiring	5
4. Worked example — a capability gap assessment	5
5. Using the framework for development	6
6. What not to use the framework for	6
7. Checklist	7
Related	7
Sources and standards	7
Status and version	8

Using the Body of Knowledge: a guide for employers

In one paragraph. This document explains how to use the thirteen-domain framework behind the PCL-AI credential for three jobs it does well: writing a role specification that describes competence rather than tools, structuring an interview that tests judgement, and assessing a controls function's capability gaps with a weighted coverage measure. It includes a worked gap assessment and a checklist.

Who this is for. Heads of project controls, PMO leads, engineering and commercial directors, and the hiring managers and HR business partners who write the specification and sit on the panel.

— 1. What the credential tells you before you use the framework

A PCL-AI holder has demonstrated competence against a published thirteen-domain framework, at a published standard, in one ninety-minute examination scored criterion-referenced rather than on a curve. The propositions they claim to be able to act on are in [PCB-04](#); the limits on that claim — point-in-time validity, no accreditation, no outcome guarantee, separation from membership grades — are in [PCB-01 – The Project Controls Body of Knowledge – executive summary](#) §5, and should be read before relying on it.

Three points bear specifically on hiring. **Eligibility is three years' professional experience in any field**, not three years in project controls, so sector and domain experience remain yours to assess. **One route requires no examination**: of the three published routes — standard, founding member, honorary fellow — the honorary route involves no sitting, so verify which route earned a credential that matters to a decision ([CER-04 – Routes into PCI: standard, founding, honorary](#)). And **PCI owns the standard and the examination while Certuvo is the separate official training partner**; the certification decision is independent of who prepared the candidate, or whether anyone did.

— 2. Using the domains as a role specification

Most controls specifications describe software, which selects for tool familiarity and produces a role rewritten every time the tool changes. A published framework lets you specify competence and treat the tool as a training item.

The method takes about an hour. Mark each of the thirteen domains **required**, **supporting** or **not applicable**; then for each required domain name the artefact the post-holder owns, its frequency, and its reviewer. That last step turns a framework into a specification. "Domain 6 required" tells a candidate nothing; "owns the monthly earned value report across fourteen control accounts, published to the project board by working day five, reviewed by the controls manager" tells them exactly what they are applying for.

A pattern for three common posts — a starting point, not a standard:

Post	Required domains	Supporting	Typical owned artefact
Cost engineer	1, 3, 5, 6	2, 7, 11, 12	Monthly cost report and commitment register
Planner / scheduler	3, 6, 10, 12	8, 9, 5	Baselined and progressed schedule, critical-path narrative
Controls manager	3, 4, 5, 6, 10, 12	all remaining	Integrated monthly report and the estimate at completion

Two rules keep this honest. **Do not require all thirteen domains for every post** — a specification requiring everything selects for candidates willing to overstate and leaves the role impossible to develop into. And **do not use the examination group weights as a role weighting**: forty per cent examination weight on finance is not forty per cent of a cost engineer's week.

— 3. Using the framework in hiring

A domain map beats a competency form as an interview structure, because it produces questions with right answers. Use one probe per required domain — the probes in [PCB-04 §2](#) are written for this and share a shape worth copying: give a situation and a little data, then ask what the candidate would do next and why. One who names the cause of a variance before selecting a forecasting method is demonstrating judgement; one who names a formula is demonstrating recall.

Three additions earn their place on any panel. **Ask for the working, not the tool** — "show me how you would find total float on this ten-activity network" cannot be answered from a template. **Ask one question about being wrong** — "tell me about a forecast you defended that turned out optimistic: what did you miss, and what changed afterwards?" There is no correct answer; you are assessing whether the candidate treats a forecast as a position they own. **Ask one AI question and score the governance, not the enthusiasm** — "you have an AI-generated variance narrative; which two figures do you verify before it goes to the board, and against what?" Do not ask candidates to reproduce examination content: sample items are published study material, live content never is.

— 4. Worked example — a capability gap assessment

Illustrative figures. A management heuristic, not a PCI instrument — the Institute publishes no such index. A controls function of nine people. For each domain the head of function records how many of the nine can work **unsupervised** in it: one deliberately blunt judgement made in a single session, not a survey. Group A: D1 = 2, D2 = 1, D3 = 7, D4 = 6. Group B: D5 = 8, D6 = 5, D7 = 4, D8 = 6, D9 = 2, D10 = 7, D11 = 1, D12 = 4. Group C: D13 = 1. Figures computed unrounded, shown to one decimal place.

Step 1 — unweighted coverage. Competent person-domains = $16 + 37 + 1 = 54$; slots = $13 \times 9 = 117$. Unweighted coverage = $54 \div 117 = 46.2\%$

Step 2 — coverage by group, the mean count across the group's domains, over the nine people. Group A = $(2 + 1 + 7 + 6) \div 4 = 4.000 \rightarrow 4.000 \div 9 = 44.4\%$ Group B = $(8 + 5 + 4 + 6 + 2 + 7 + 1 + 4) \div 8 = 4.625 \rightarrow 4.625 \div 9 = 51.4\%$ Group C = $1 \div 1 = 1.000 \rightarrow 1.000 \div 9 = 11.1\%$

Step 3 — the weighted index, at the published group weights of 0.40, 0.40 and 0.20. $\text{Index} = (0.40 \times 0.4444) + (0.40 \times 0.5139) + (0.20 \times 0.1111) = 0.1778 + 0.2056 + 0.0222 = 40.6 \%$

That sits 5.6 percentage points below the unweighted 46.2 per cent, because the thinnest coverage — one person in nine in Domain 13 — is where a fifth of the framework's weight rests on a single domain. The headline number flatters the function; the weighted one does not.

Step 4 — two development options, each adding four person-domain competencies.

Option 1 — four people developed in Domain 13, taking D13 from 1 to 5. $\text{Group C} = 5 \div 9 = 55.6 \%$; $\text{Index} = 0.1778 + 0.2056 + (0.20 \times 0.5556) = 49.4 \%$

Option 2 — two people in Domain 1 and two in Domain 2, taking D1 from 2 to 4 and D2 from 1 to 3. $\text{Group A} = (4 + 3 + 7 + 6) \div 4 = 5.000 \rightarrow 5.000 \div 9 = 55.6 \%$; $\text{Index} = (0.40 \times 0.5556) + 0.2056 + 0.0222 = 45.0 \%$

Option 1 moves the index by 8.9 percentage points, option 2 by 4.4 — **exactly twice the movement for the same training effort**, because the twenty per cent AI weight rides on one domain while the forty per cent finance weight spreads across four.

The warning that makes this usable. That doubling is an artefact of the arithmetic, not a finding about your team: the index is twice as sensitive to Domain 13, which is not to say the training is twice as valuable to your projects. If the live problem is a disputed revenue position, option 2 is the right decision and the index the wrong instrument. Use it to find where you are thin, never to choose what to do about it.

— 5. Using the framework for development

Find the single points of failure first. A domain covered by one person is a resilience problem before it is a capability problem. Here that is Domains 11 and 13 — and business process cycles is the one most functions never think to develop, because it looks like finance's job until an invoice dispute proves otherwise.

Set development against artefacts, not courses. "Understands earned value" is unassessable. "Produces the monthly estimate at completion for two control accounts, reviewed by the controls manager, for three consecutive months" has a completion test; [CAR-07 – Building a portfolio of evidence](#) covers how an individual records it.

Sponsor certification deliberately. An examination validates knowledge; it does not substitute for the development above. Fees are route-dependent and discountable: [\[CONFIRM: examination fee — platform seeds USD 500, legacy candidate pack states USD 350\]](#). Budget also for recertification on a three-year cycle with its mandatory AI-currency component; the student portal shows a target of thirty hours of continuing professional development per cycle, but [\[CONFIRM: the binding CPD requirement, to be published with the recertification rules\]](#).

— 6. What not to use the framework for

Not as a pay scale — PCI publishes no salary data, and any figure attributed to the Institute today is not ours. **Not to screen out non-certified candidates** — its hiring value is the structure it gives your questions, which works identically on people who hold nothing. **Not as accreditation, to your client** — "our team is PCI-certified" is accurate; implying accredited or government-

recognised certification is not. **Not for the sibling credentials** — it is PCL-AI only, and no blueprint exists yet for PFL-AI or PML-AI.

— 7. Checklist

- [] Every open post marks each of the thirteen domains required, supporting or not applicable
 - [] Every required domain names its artefact, frequency and reviewer; no post requires all thirteen
 - [] Group weights are not being used as a role or workload weighting
 - [] The interview has one judgement probe per required domain, plus one "being wrong" question
 - [] The AI question scores governance and verification, not tool enthusiasm
 - [] Team coverage is recorded per domain, with single points of failure flagged
 - [] Development objectives are artefacts produced and reviewed, not courses attended
 - [] Any credential relied on has been verified, including which route earned it
 - [] No accreditation, recognition or outcome claim is being made on PCI's behalf
-

— Related

- [PCB-01 – The Project Controls Body of Knowledge – executive summary](#) — what the credential asserts and its limits
- [PCB-02 – The thirteen domains at a glance](#) — the domain map used for the specification method in §2
- [PCB-04 – What a project controls professional must know](#) — the probes to build an interview from
- [CMP-10 – Assessing competence – evidence, rubrics, moderation](#) — a rigorous alternative to the heuristic in §4
- [CER-04 – Routes into PCI: standard, founding, honorary](#) — why route verification matters in §1
- [CAR-07 – Building a portfolio of evidence](#) — the individual counterpart to the development plan in §5

— Sources and standards

- PCL-AI Body of Knowledge, first authored draft ([docs/bok/](#)), August 2026: the thirteen domains and sixty-one knowledge areas used throughout.
 - Examination Blueprint ([docs/downloads/examination-blueprint.md](#)), August 2026: §2, the group weights applied in §4; §6, the blueprint's published limits, including that it guarantees nothing about outcomes.
 - PCI Canonical Facts ([docs/publication-framework/00-framework/CANONICAL-FACTS.md](#)), verified August 2026: §2.1 accreditation wording, §4 examination configuration and recertification, §4.3 the unresolved fee conflict, §4.4 eligibility, §5 application routes, §6 membership grades.
-

ISO/IEC 17024 is named as the personnel-certification standard the framework is developed with reference to. No edition, clause or wording is cited, because none was verified for this document. The capability assessment in §4 uses illustrative figures and represents no real organisation or team.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 · draft · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.